

Cohere

Enterprise AI · Toronto, Canada / San Francisco, CA · Private (~\$7B valuation; ~\$240M ARR; IPO 'soon')

Enterprise-AI champion Cohere has reached ~\$240M ARR at a ~\$7B valuation, installed its first CFO and signalled an IPO is coming 'soon' - a security-conscious, Canadian 'sovereign AI' leader with no motorsport footprint and a clean fit for Formula E's enterprise-and-sustainability audience.

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OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Nissan Formula E

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

Cohere is an enterprise-focused AI company (co-headquartered in Toronto and San Francisco) that has reached roughly \$240M in ARR - beating its own \$200M target - at a valuation of about \$7B following a \$500M August 2025 round (struck at \$6.8B and since extended). It has just built out an IPO-grade leadership bench: a first CFO in ex-Uber finance chief Francois Chadwick, a Chief AI Officer in ex-Meta research head Joelle Pineau, and a CEO, Aidan Gomez, who has said publicly that a listing is coming 'soon'. Unlike consumer-AI labs, Cohere's whole positioning is enterprise-grade, secure, deployable 'sovereign AI you can trust in production' - a register that fits Formula E's enterprise-and-sustainability audience far better than a saturated F1 fintech lane. No frontier or enterprise-AI brand currently holds a Formula E team partnership, so the category is open, and an FE entry would give Cohere a differentiated, internationally-credible brand stage as it builds toward the public markets.

WHY NOW

With a first CFO installed and the CEO publicly guiding to an IPO 'soon', Cohere is squarely in the pre-listing brand-building window - when enterprise credibility is most valuable - and the enterprise-AI category in Formula E is empty. Moving now rewards a first mover before peers (and the larger AI labs) recognise the same open lane, while category exclusivity is uncontested and inexpensive.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

~\$240M

ARR (beat its own \$200M target, Feb 2026)

~\$7B

Valuation (Sep 2025, after the August round)

\$500M

August 2025 round (struck at a \$6.8B valuation)

Francois Chadwick

First CFO (ex-Uber) - an IPO-readiness signal

Aidan Gomez

Co-founder & CEO; has said an IPO is coming 'soon'

Nissan FE - no AI partner

Recommended team's AI lane is clean (partners: Alpine Tech, Marelli, Coral)

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Nissan	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Porsche	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Jaguar TCS Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
DS Penske	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A ~\$7B enterprise-AI champion at ~\$240M ARR with a brand-new ex-Uber CFO and an IPO its CEO says is coming 'soon' - and Formula E's enterprise-AI lane sits empty. Nissan, with no AI partner, is the open founding seat. Move before a rival lab notices.

NEVER ENTEREDFUNDING EVENTCATEGORY WHITESPACENEW LEADERSHIPDISCOVERY: SELF

WHY NISSAN FORMULA E

Nissan is the fit: a global EV pioneer with deep Formula E pedigree and an international, technology-forward brand that pairs naturally with Cohere's Canadian-and-Californian, enterprise-AI identity. The team's electric-mobility story and Cohere's 'practical AI for real enterprises' story reinforce each other, and Nissan's audience skews to exactly the kind of large, regulated enterprises Cohere sells to.

VALUE TO NISSAN FORMULA E — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A. AI-driven race strategy, energy-management modelling for an all-electric car, and large-scale data analysis are genuine Formula E problems where Cohere's enterprise models could be deployed as a working technical partnership, not just branding. Nissan gains a real AI collaboration and a credible innovation narrative; Cohere gains a live, demonstrable deployment it can reference with enterprise buyers and investors.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Enterprise AI Partner tier on Nissan Formula E, minimum three years, ~\$3-5M/yr, with AI-category exclusivity and a defined technical workstream (strategy/energy modelling) so the partnership has substance.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Aidan Gomez

CO-FOUNDER & CEO, COHERE - VERIFIED (NO CMO; THE PRESIDENT/COO SEAT WAS VACATED WHEN MARTIN KON MOVED TO AN ADVISORY/BOARD ROLE IN 2025)

Cohere is founder-led and Gomez is closely involved in brand and strategic-partnership decisions, so the CEO is the correct entry point - there is no CMO, and former President/COO Martin Kon stepped into an advisory role in 2025. Co-decision-maker on spend: Francois Chadwick, hired in 2025 as Cohere's first CFO (ex-Uber), who owns the IPO-readiness budget. A MODE-A technical workstream would also engage Chief AI Officer Joelle Pineau (ex-Meta research head).

OPENING ANGLE

"Aidan, Cohere's whole edge is enterprise-grade, deployable AI - Formula E is the enterprise-and-sustainability grid, and no AI brand owns it yet. Nissan has no AI partner and a real strategy/energy workstream waiting - not a logo. 25 minutes before a rival lab notices?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 15 / 20 An IPO is now a near-dated event: Cohere installed its first CFO (ex-Uber Francois Chadwick) in 2025 and CEO Aidan Gomez has said a listing is coming 'soon' - the classic pre-IPO brand-building window.	CAPACITY 16 / 20 ~\$7B valuation and ~\$240M ARR (beat its own \$200M target), well capitalised for an FE entry tier.	BRAND FIT 16 / 20 Enterprise, security-conscious 'sovereign AI' positioning fits a sustainability-led, internationally-rooted championship; Canadian identity pairs naturally with Nissan's global EV story.	URGENCY 12 / 20 Enterprise-AI brands are racing for mindshare, but there is no acute external clock.	OPS FIT 14 / 20 MODE A: AI for race strategy, energy modelling and data analysis is a credible team use case.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

FOUNDER-LED BRAND CAUTION AI labs often deprioritise sponsorship as off-strategy. **Counter:** Frame as enterprise credibility, a live technical reference deployment, and a talent magnet in a fierce AI recruiting market - not consumer marketing.

NO DATED TRIGGER Without an acute clock, the deal can drift. **Counter:** Use category exclusivity as the urgency: it disappears the moment a rival AI brand signs an FE team.

SOURCES

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